

On the other hand, GIMP has some level of support for running Photoshop plugins through the PSPI extension. You can also run some Photoshop Actions through the GIMP-sharp extension. This makes it easier for people transitioning from Photoshop to GIMP to get their footing in the software. Even Photoshop colour curves can be converted to GIMP colour curves. Photoshop, on the other hand, has no such features that let users run GIMP plugins.

Adobe Photoshop has the added advantage of being able to use your system's GPU for processing your files. GIMP does not have access to that kind of processing power (not yet, anyway). Even the RAM usage of both softwares differs exponentially. These are both critical features highlighting why Photoshop is a class apart from GIMP other than for being a commercial software.

Brushes are another problem in GIMP. Photoshop started off as a software for digital painting. GIMP has had no such background. While GIMP does have some little support for the MyPaint brushes, it's still at an experimental stage, while Photoshop's brushes are things of legend. This also explains why Photoshop's support for drawing tabs is also so strong, leaving GIMP in the dust.

Conclusion:

Clearly, when it comes to raw features, Photoshop has GIMP in a vice grip. However, considering the fact that GIMP is an open source software without the money and backing that Photoshop has from Adobe, it's doing quite well. GIMP has adapted most of Photoshop's highlighted features with relative ease. Photoshop's comfort with adjustment layers and its smooth workflow is taking its time to make it to GIMP's basic functionality, but it's only a matter of time.

It's true that in cases like this, the side with the money generally wins. This is that kind of a scenario. Very little can change on that front. However, as far as open source software are concerned, even rich kids like Photoshop have to up their game to stay ahead of the curve. 